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PR 33 | Q3 2026 Hypothetical 2028 Head-to-Head Match-up: VP Duterte vs. Mayor Robredo

Q3 2026 TUGON NG MASA (TNM) SURVEY:
Report to Media on:

2028 Presidential Voting Preference:
VP Sara Duterte vs. Mayor Leni Robredo in a Hypothetical 2028 Matchup

November 3, 2026

We are pleased to share key findings from the third quarter Tugon ng Masa (TNM) nationwide survey, an independent and non-partisan poll conducted regularly by OCTA Research. The survey results reported here are non-commissioned and focus on **a hypothetical head-to-head vote-intention matchup between VP Sara Duterte and Mayor Leni Robredo for the 2028 presidential elections**. These findings are released as a public service by OCTA Research.

The survey fieldwork was conducted from September 28 to October 4, 2026, using face-to-face interviews. A total of 1,200 probability respondents aged 18 and above, both male and female, were interviewed for the study. The survey has a ±3% margin of error at a 95% confidence level. Please note that the **Q3 2026 TNM survey results reflect an early-stage hypothetical vote-intention measure** and should be interpreted as a snapshot of current public sentiment, not as a prediction of electoral outcomes.

An infographic summary of the report is also included for reference. For access to the complete survey results, detailed data tables, and related survey probes, or for any clarifications regarding the TNM survey, please contact OCTA Research Fellows Mr. Ranjit Rye or Mr. Guido David at octaresearchphilippines@gmail.com.

Additional survey releases and public briefing materials may also be accessed through the OCTA website at https://www.octaresearch.com or via its official Facebook page at https://www.facebook.com/OCTAResearch.

Thank you for your continued support in helping disseminate these survey findings to the public.

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Mayor Leni Robredo Now Seven Points Behind VP Sara Duterte, 33% to 40%, in a Hypothetical 2028 Matchup — the Closest OCTA Has Recorded Between the Two

VP Sara Duterte's numbers show a softening across the three 2026 waves, with her share easing from 46% in Q1 to 43% in Q2 and 40% in Q3, a cumulative six-point decline that exceeds the ±3% margin of error. As a result, the gap between VP Duterte and Mayor Leni Robredo has narrowed in each wave, from 11 points to 9 and now 7. In OCTA's unpublished commissioned surveys in 2025, VP Duterte led by roughly 20 to 25 points. The two-point narrowing since Q2 is within the margin of error, but all three waves move in the same direction. Mayor Robredo has held at 33% to 35% across all three waves, even after ruling out a 2028 run, while the undecided share has risen to 26%.

Executive Summary

The third quarter 2026 Tugon ng Masa (TNM) survey shows the gap between **VP Sara Duterte** and **Mayor Leni Robredo** in a hypothetical 2028 presidential matchup at **seven points (40% to 33%)**. This is the narrowest OCTA has recorded between the two. Twenty-six percent are undecided or choose neither candidate, and 1% refuse to answer. The gap has narrowed in each 2026 wave, from eleven points in Q1 to nine in Q2 and seven in Q3. It is also well below VP Duterte's leads of roughly 20 to 25 points in OCTA's 2025 commissioned surveys, which were not publicly released. The Q2-to-Q3 change is within the margin of error, but the consistent direction across three waves is the key feature of this release. VP Duterte still leads nationally, and her seven-point lead is outside the margin of error.

Between Q2 and Q3, VP Duterte's national share moved from 43% to 40%, Mayor Robredo's from 34% to 33%, and the undecided/none/don't know bloc from 22% to 26%. These quarter-to-quarter differences are mostly within or near the survey's ±3% margin of error. Across the three 2026 waves, VP Duterte's share is six points lower than in Q1 (46% to 40%), Mayor Robredo's is two points lower (35% to 33%), and the undecided share is seven points higher (19% to 26%). **The three-wave figures may suggest some softening in VP Duterte's numbers and some growth in the uncommitted bloc; further waves would be needed to determine whether this reflects a sustained pattern.**

Mayor Robredo's national share has stayed within a 33% to 35% range across the three waves, even as she has said she will not seek national office in 2028. The narrowing of the gap therefore reflects lower figures for VP Duterte rather than gains for Mayor Robredo.

Beneath the topline, the Q3 figures differ considerably across groups. Mayor Robredo leads in NCR (39% to 32%), in Class ABC (40% to 32%), and narrowly among urban residents and women, while in Class E, Mayor Robredo's share rose substantially this quarter, by 11 points (31% to 42%), drawing level with VP Duterte (41%). VP Duterte leads in Mindanao and the Visayas, among rural residents, men, and voters under 45, and in Class D, the largest socioeconomic group. Age differences in Q3 are smaller than those recorded in Q2.

With the undecided bloc (26%) now more than three times the size of VP Duterte's lead (7 points), and with the Senate impeachment trial still unresolved during fieldwork, the contest remains an early and unsettled snapshot — not a prediction of the May 2028 outcome.

Key Insights

1. **The gap is down to seven points, the narrowest in OCTA's 2026 tracking, and has narrowed every quarter.** Nationwide, 40% of adult Filipinos would vote for VP Duterte if the May 2028 elections were held today, compared with 33% for Mayor Robredo. The gap was eleven points in Q1 (46% to 35%) and nine in Q2 (43% to 34%). VP Duterte's lead was roughly 20 to 25 points in OCTA's unpublished commissioned surveys in 2025. Taken alone, the two-point narrowing since Q2 is within the margin of error. Across three waves, however, the direction has been consistent. VP Duterte still leads, and her lead is outside the margin of error.

2. **The narrowing reflects VP Duterte's lower figures, not a gain for Mayor Robredo.** Mayor Robredo's share has been steady at 35%, 34% and 33%. Over the same period, VP Duterte's share fell six points and the undecided share rose seven. This suggests that voters moving away from VP Duterte are holding back from a choice rather than shifting to Mayor Robredo. The large undecided bloc gives Mayor Robredo, who is not a declared candidate, room to grow, but it does not yet show her growing.

3. **The undecided share is the largest in OCTA's 2026 tracking.** The undecided/none/don't know share is 26%. It is higher than in Q2 in Mindanao (18% to

25%) and Class D (21% to 28%), and roughly one in three voters aged 18 to 34 choose neither candidate.

4. **Mayor Robredo's national share is stable.** Her national share has been 35%, 34% and 33% across the three waves. In NCR, her share is 39% in Q3, compared with 34% in Q2 and 52% in Q1, and she leads VP Duterte there by seven points.

5. **Results by socioeconomic class vary.** In Class ABC, Mayor Robredo has 40% and VP Duterte 32% (Q2: 27% and 36%). In Class E, Mayor Robredo gained 11 points this quarter, from 31% to 42%, while VP Duterte's share went from 51% to 41%, leaving the two statistically tied — the largest swing in any socioeconomic class this quarter. In Class D, the largest group, VP Duterte leads 41% to 31% (Q2: 43% and 36%), with 28% undecided. Because the ABC and E subsamples are small, these figures may reflect sampling variation as well as differences in preference, and should be read with caution.

6. **Age differences are smaller; locale and gender differences are larger.** VP Duterte leads in all age groups under 45 and Mayor Robredo narrowly in all groups 45 and above, with smaller margins than in Q2. Mayor Robredo leads narrowly in urban areas (38% to 35%) and among women (38% to 35%), while VP Duterte leads by 22 points in rural areas and by 17 points among men.

7. **VP Duterte leads in Mindanao and the Visayas.** She leads 71% to 2% in Mindanao and 46% to 27% in the Visayas. Her Mindanao share is 71% in Q3, compared with 76% in Q2 and 88% in Q1.

8. **This is an early benchmark, not a forecast.** The survey tests a single hypothetical pairing roughly 19 months before the May 2028 elections, involving one prospective candidate who has said she will not run and another whose impeachment trial was ongoing during fieldwork. Candidate filings, alliances, the trial's outcome, and shifting public issues can substantially change these preferences.

A. Context

The third quarter 2026 Tugon ng Masa (TNM) survey was conducted from September 28 to October 4, 2026, through face-to-face interviews with 1,200 adult respondents aged 18 and above nationwide. The survey employed probability-based sampling and has a ±3 percentage-point margin of error at the 95% confidence level.

As in previous releases, OCTA situates the findings within the political environment of the fieldwork period. Doing so provides useful context for interpreting the results, but the survey does not establish causal relationships between these developments and respondents' voting preferences.

Fieldwork coincided with an active phase of the Senate impeachment trial of Vice President Sara Duterte, which opened in July 2026. In the days before and during fieldwork, the proceedings centered on the prosecution's evidence regarding alleged unexplained wealth and corporate interests. On September 23, the impeachment court voted to lower the vote threshold required for conviction. On September 29, during fieldwork, Davao City Mayor Sebastian Duterte testified before the court, and the court ruled that the Vice President could not be compelled to admit ownership of bank accounts whose records had been submitted as evidence. On October 2, the court's spokesperson said a verdict could be issued as early as December 16. The Vice President had earlier declared her intention to seek the presidency in 2028.

Developments after fieldwork closed — including the prosecution's withdrawal on October 13 of three of the four articles of impeachment, leaving the charge relating to unexplained wealth — are not reflected in these results.

Mayor Leni Robredo's stated position on 2028 has not changed since April 2026, when she ruled out a run for national office and indicated that she would likely seek a second term as mayor of Naga City. Because Mayor Robredo is not a prospective candidate by her own account, her inclusion in this matchup is best read as a measure of her standing with voters rather than as a test of an actual candidacy.

These conditions frame — but do not explain — the figures reported below. The survey did not ask respondents whether the impeachment proceedings or Mayor Robredo's statements affected their choices, and no causal conclusion should therefore be drawn.

B. Technical Report

VP Sara Duterte continues to lead Mayor Leni Robredo in a hypothetical two-candidate presidential matchup. Nationwide, 40% of adult Filipinos say they would vote for VP Duterte if the May 2028 elections were held at the time of the survey, compared with 33% who choose Mayor Robredo. Twenty-six percent select none of the candidates or say they do not know, while 1% refuse to answer (see Table 1). Among the 1,170 respondents who reported being registered voters, the results are identical: 40% for VP Duterte, 33% for Mayor Robredo, and 26% undecided.

TABLE 1
CURRENT PRESIDENTIAL VOTING PREFERENCE
September 28–October 4, 2026 / Philippines
(in Percent)

Base: Total Interviews								
If the May 2028 elections were held today, who will you vote for as President?	PH	AREA				SOCIOECONOMIC CLASS		
		NCR	BL	VIS	MIN	ABC	D	E
DUTERTE, SARA	40	32	24	46	71	32	41	41
ROBREDO, LENI	33	39	49	27	2	40	31	42
None/Don't Know	26	29	26	26	25	25	28	17
Refused	1	1	0	0	2	3	0	0

Notes: Figures may not add up to 100% due to rounding off. Sample size of 1,200 with ±3% margin of error.

Across the four major geographic areas, voting preference remains sharply divided. Mayor Robredo leads in NCR, 39% to 32%, with 29% selecting none or saying they do not know, and posts her strongest major-area showing in Balance Luzon, 49% to 24%. VP Duterte leads in the Visayas, 46% to 27%, and records her strongest showing in Mindanao, where she receives 71% compared with Mayor Robredo's 2%. The survey's data tables flag Mayor Robredo's NCR and Balance Luzon shares, and VP Duterte's Visayas and Mindanao shares, as significantly higher than the corresponding national figures at the 95% confidence level.

By socioeconomic class, the picture is more varied than in previous quarters. Mayor Robredo leads among Class ABC, 40% to 32%. VP Duterte leads among Class D, 41% to 31%, with 28% undecided. In Class E, Mayor Robredo registers 42%, up 11 points from Q2, and is statistically tied with VP Duterte at 41%. Because Class D accounts for roughly four in five adult Filipinos, VP Duterte's advantage within it continues to anchor her national lead (see Table 1).

Regional results reveal wide variation. Mayor Robredo records her highest preferences in Cagayan Valley (63%), Central Luzon (54%), Ilocos Region (50%), Western Visayas (49%), and CALABARZON (47%), while VP Duterte receives very high preferences in CARAGA (80%), BARMM (79%), Davao Region (74%), Central Visayas (73%), Zamboanga Peninsula (67%), SOCCSKSARGEN (66%), and Northern Mindanao (64%). The Visayas are not uniform: Western Visayas leans toward Mayor Robredo (49% to 18%), while Central Visayas leans heavily toward VP Duterte (73% to 6%). Large undecided shares are recorded in Bicol Region (39%), Western Visayas (32%), Northern Mindanao (31%), and CALABARZON (30%). Because regional sample sizes are small — between 10 and 100 respondents — these estimates are less precise than the national figures and should be interpreted with caution (detailed regional tables are available upon request).

Ethnolinguistic patterns broadly track this geography. Mayor Robredo leads among respondents of Tagalog/Filipino background (44% to 28%) and Ilocano background (56% to 19%), while VP Duterte leads by a wide margin among Cebuano/Bisaya respondents (70% to 7%). Ilonggo respondents are closely divided (38% for VP Duterte, 35% for Mayor Robredo).

Voting preferences continue to differ by age, though the differences are smaller than in Q2. VP Duterte leads among younger and middle-aged respondents: 40% to 25% among those aged 18 to 24, 44% to 21% among those aged 25 to 34, and 48% to 26% among those aged 35 to 44. Mayor Robredo holds narrow leads among all older age groups: 40% to 37% among those aged 45 to 54, 42% to 36% among those aged 55 to 64, 41% to 35% among those aged 65 to 74, and 42% to 39% among those aged 75 and above. The undecided share is highest among the youngest voters, with roughly one in three respondents aged 18 to 24 (35%) and 25 to 34 (34%) choosing neither candidate (see Table 2).

TABLE 2
CURRENT PRESIDENTIAL VOTING PREFERENCE BY AGE GROUP
September 28–October 4, 2026 / Philippines
(in Percent)

Base: Total Interviews								
If the May 2028 elections were held today, who will you vote for as President?	PH	AGE GROUP						
		18-24	25-34	35-44	45-54	55-64	65-74	75+
DUTERTE, SARA	40	40	44	48	37	36	35	39
ROBREDO, LENI	33	25	21	26	40	42	41	42
None/Don't Know	26	35	34	23	23	22	25	18
Refused	1	1	1	2	0	1	0	1

Notes: Figures may not add up to 100% due to rounding off. Sample size of 1,200 with ±3% margin of error.

Locale and gender differences are more pronounced in Q3 than in Q2. Mayor Robredo leads narrowly in urban areas (38% to 35%), while VP Duterte leads decisively in rural areas (47% to 25%). VP Duterte leads among male respondents, 45% to 28%, while Mayor Robredo leads narrowly among female respondents, 38% to 35%. By education, VP Duterte leads among respondents with no formal or elementary education (45% to 32%) and among those with high school education (42% to 32%). Mayor Robredo leads among those with vocational education (46% to 22%), although this subgroup is small (50 respondents). Among college-educated and postgraduate respondents, the two are nearly level — 35% for VP Duterte and 33% for Mayor Robredo — with 29% undecided (see Table 3).

TABLE 3
CURRENT PRESIDENTIAL VOTING PREFERENCE BY LOCALE, GENDER & EDUCATION
September 28–October 4, 2026 / Philippines
(in Percent)

Base: Total Interviews									
If the May 2028 elections were held today, who will you vote for as President?	PH	LOCALE		GENDER		EDUCATION			
		URBAN	RURAL	MALE	FEMALE	NO FORMAL/ ELEM	HIGH SCHOOL	VOCA-TIONAL	COLLEGE+
DUTERTE, SARA	40	35	47	45	35	45	42	22	35
ROBREDO, LENI	33	38	25	28	38	32	32	46	33
None/Don't Know	26	26	27	27	26	21	26	32	29
Refused	1	1	0	0	1	1	0	0	2

Notes: Figures may not add up to 100% due to rounding off. Sample size of 1,200 with ±3% margin of error.

Taken together, the Q3 results show VP Duterte with a national lead, supported by strong preferences in Mindanao and the Visayas, in rural areas, and among men, voters under 45, and Class D. Mayor Robredo leads in Balance Luzon and NCR, among older voters, women, and urban residents, and in Class ABC, while in Class E she drew level with VP Duterte after an 11-point gain this quarter. The next section compares these figures with those from Q2 and Q1 2026.

C. Comparative Analysis: Q2 vs. Q3 2026

C.1. A Note on Reading Quarter-to-Quarter Change

All three TNM waves in 2026 — Q1, Q2 and Q3 — carry a ±3% margin of error at the 95% confidence level, and this release uses that ±3% margin as the benchmark for reading quarter-to-quarter differences. Differences of three points or less are treated as within the margin of error. Larger differences may indicate a change in preference, but estimates for smaller subgroups — major areas, regions, socioeconomic classes, and age and education groups — rest on fewer interviews and are less precise than the national figures, so differences within them may also reflect sampling variation.

The ±3% figure applies to each candidate's share. The margin of error on the gap between two candidates is wider, so changes in the lead itself should be read with additional caution.

Measured against this benchmark, the Q2-to-Q3 national differences — three points for VP Duterte, one point for Mayor Robredo, four points for the undecided share, and two points in the gap between the two — are mostly within or near the ±3% margin of error.

The three-wave comparison. Compared with Q1, VP Duterte's national share is six points lower and the uncommitted share seven points higher, each roughly twice the ±3% margin of error. Several subnational and demographic differences are also larger than the margin and are described where they occur, including VP Duterte's Mindanao share since Q1, Mayor Robredo's NCR share since Q1, the Class ABC and Class E figures, the undecided share in Class D, and VP Duterte's share among voters aged 25 to 34. Because many of these rest on small subsamples, they may reflect sampling variation as well as changes in preference, and are presented as patterns to monitor rather than conclusions.

C.2. The Gap Narrows to Seven Points; VP Duterte Still Leads

VP Sara Duterte remains ahead of Mayor Leni Robredo in the hypothetical 2028 presidential matchup. The gap between the two is seven points in Q3, compared with nine points in Q2 and eleven in Q1 (see Table 4).

TABLE 4
NATIONAL PRESIDENTIAL VOTING PREFERENCE, Q1–Q3 2026
Q1 vs. Q2 vs. Q3 2026 (in Percent)

National Preference	Q1 2026	Q2 2026	Q3 2026	Q2→Q3	Q1→Q3
VP Sara Duterte	46%	43%	40%	−3 points	−6 points
Mayor Leni Robredo	35%	34%	33%	−1 point	−2 points

National Preference	Q1 2026	Q2 2026	Q3 2026	Q2→Q3	Q1→Q3
Undecided/None/Don't Know	19%	22%	26%	+4 points	+7 points
Duterte's lead	11 points	9 points	7 points	−2 points	−4 points

VP Duterte's national share is 40% in Q3 (43% in Q2), while Mayor Robredo's is 33% (34% in Q2). The seven-point gap is the smallest OCTA has recorded between the two in 2026, and narrower than VP Duterte's leads of roughly 20 to 25 percentage points recorded in OCTA's commissioned surveys in 2025. Because those 2025 surveys were commissioned, were not publicly released, and may differ in design from the non-commissioned TNM series, this comparison may be read as broad context rather than a like-for-like trend. Neither candidate commands majority support.

The lower figure for VP Duterte is not matched by a higher figure for Mayor Robredo. The share of respondents who were undecided, selected neither candidate, or did not know is 26%, compared with 22% in Q2 — the largest uncommitted share in OCTA's 2026 tracking of this matchup.

Across the three waves, VP Duterte's share is 46%, 43% and 40%; Mayor Robredo's is 35%, 34% and 33%; and the uncommitted share is 19%, 22% and 26%. Each quarterly difference is modest. The cumulative differences for VP Duterte and for the uncommitted bloc are larger than the margin of error and may indicate a pattern worth monitoring; the two-point difference for Mayor Robredo is within it.

TABLE 5
PRESIDENTIAL VOTING PREFERENCE BY MAJOR AREA, Q1–Q3 2026
Q1 vs. Q2 vs. Q3 2026 (in Percent)

Area / Candidate	Q1 2026	Q2 2026	Q3 2026	Change (Q2→Q3)
NCR — Duterte	32%	34%	32%	−2
NCR — Robredo	52%	34%	39%	+5
NCR — Undecided	~15%	32%	29%	−3
Balance Luzon — Duterte	25%	27%	24%	−3
Balance Luzon — Robredo	47%	51%	49%	−2
Balance Luzon — Undecided	—	21%	26%	+5
Visayas — Duterte	53%	51%	46%	−5
Visayas — Robredo	34%	26%	27%	+1
Visayas — Undecided	—	23%	26%	+3
Mindanao — Duterte	88%	76%	71%	−5
Mindanao — Robredo	3%	6%	2%	−4
Mindanao — Undecided	—	18%	25%	+7

Note: Q1 2026 undecided figures by area were not reported in earlier releases, except for NCR (roughly 15%).

C.3. NCR: Mayor Robredo Leads, 39% to 32%

In Q2, NCR was tied at 34% each, after a 20-point lead for Mayor Robredo in Q1. In Q3, Mayor Robredo's share is 39%, VP Duterte's 32%, and the undecided share 29% (32% in

Q2), giving Mayor Robredo a seven-point lead. The five-point difference in Mayor Robredo's share from Q2 is beyond the ±3% margin of error, but because NCR rests on a smaller subsample of 300 interviews, it may reflect sampling variation as well as a change in preference.

Compared with Q1, Mayor Robredo's NCR share is 13 points lower (52% to 39%). VP Duterte's NCR share has been within a 32% to 34% range across all three waves. The NCR figures may suggest that movement there has been mainly between Mayor Robredo and the undecided column, though the data alone cannot confirm this.

C.4. Balance Luzon: Mayor Robredo Leads, 49% to 24%

Balance Luzon remains Mayor Robredo's strongest major area. Her share is 49% (51% in Q2) and VP Duterte's 24% (27% in Q2), differences within or at the edge of the ±3% margin of error; the gap is 25 points (24 in Q2). The undecided share is 26% (21% in Q2). Within Balance Luzon, Mayor Robredo's share is higher in North Luzon (53%) than in South Luzon (45%), where 32% are undecided, including 41% in rural South Luzon.

C.5. Visayas: VP Duterte Leads, 46% to 27%

VP Duterte leads in the Visayas, 46% to 27%. Her share is five points lower than in Q2 (51%), while Mayor Robredo's is essentially unchanged (26% in Q2); the gap is 19 points, compared with 25 in Q2. The five-point difference is beyond the ±3% margin of error but modest for a subsample of 300 interviews, and may reflect sampling variation. Compared with Q1 (53%), VP Duterte's Visayas share is seven points lower. Within the Visayas, Central Visayas favors VP Duterte and Western Visayas favors Mayor Robredo, though both regional estimates rest on small samples.

C.6. Mindanao: VP Duterte Leads, 71% to 2%

Mindanao remains VP Duterte's strongest base, at 71% to Mayor Robredo's 2%. VP Duterte's share was 76% in Q2 and 88% in Q1. The Q2-to-Q3 difference (five points) is modest; the 17-point difference since Q1 is larger than the margin of error and may indicate some easing in the intensity of her Mindanao support.

Mayor Robredo's Mindanao share is 2% (6% in Q2). The undecided share is 25% (18% in Q2), and 2% declined to answer. These figures may suggest that some respondents in Mindanao are holding back from a choice rather than shifting to the alternative offered in this matchup.

TABLE 6
PRESIDENTIAL VOTING PREFERENCE BY SOCIOECONOMIC CLASS, Q1–Q3 2026
Q1 vs. Q2 vs. Q3 2026 (in Percent)

Class / Candidate	Q1 2026	Q2 2026	Q3 2026	Change (Q2→Q3)
ABC — Duterte	46%	36%	32%	−4
ABC — Robredo	39%	27%	40%	+13
ABC — Undecided	—	36%	25%	−11

Class / Candidate	Q1 2026	Q2 2026	Q3 2026	Change (Q2→Q3)
D — Duterte	44%	43%	41%	−2
D — Robredo	36%	36%	31%	−5
D — Undecided	—	21%	28%	+7
E — Duterte	56%	51%	41%	−10
E — Robredo	23%	31%	42%	+11
E — Undecided	—	17%	17%	No change

Note: Q1 2026 undecided figures by class were not reported in earlier releases. Class-level estimates rest on smaller subsamples and are less precise than the national figures.

C.7. Class ABC: Mayor Robredo 40%, VP Duterte 32%

In Class ABC, Mayor Robredo's share is 40% and VP Duterte's 32%, with 25% undecided. In Q2, the figures were 27% for Mayor Robredo, 36% for VP Duterte, and 36% undecided; in Q1, they were 39% for Mayor Robredo and 46% for VP Duterte. The 13-point difference in Mayor Robredo's share from Q2 is beyond the ±3% margin of error. The ABC subsample, however, is small (125 respondents), so this may reflect sampling variation as well as a change in preference, and it should be monitored in subsequent waves before any conclusion is drawn.

C.8. Class D: VP Duterte 41%, Mayor Robredo 31%

In Class D, which accounts for roughly four in five adult Filipinos, VP Duterte's share is 41% (43% in Q2) and Mayor Robredo's 31% (36% in Q2), with 28% undecided (21% in Q2). The gap is ten points, compared with seven in Q2. Given Class D's larger sample, the differences in the undecided share and in Mayor Robredo's share are beyond the ±3% margin of error and may indicate some movement toward the undecided column. Because Class D carries substantial weight in the national total, its undecided share contributes considerably to the national uncommitted figure of 26%.

C.9. Class E: Mayor Robredo Gains 11 Points, Drawing Level with VP Duterte

Class E registered the largest swing of any socioeconomic class this quarter. **Mayor Robredo's share rose substantially, by 11 points, from 31% in Q2 to 42% in Q3,** while VP Duterte's share went from 51% to 41%, leaving the two statistically tied. VP Duterte's 20-point lead in this group in Q2 has thus closed within a single quarter. Over the year, Mayor Robredo's Class E share has nearly doubled from its Q1 level (23%), when VP Duterte led by 33 points (56% to 23%). Both the quarter-to-quarter gain and the cumulative 19-point gain since Q1 are well beyond the ±3% margin of error. Because the Class E subsample is small (109 respondents), the figures may also reflect some sampling variation, and this group may warrant close monitoring in subsequent waves.

C.10. Demographic Patterns: Age, Locale, Gender and Education

Table 7 compares Q2 and Q3 figures across demographic groups.

TABLE 7
PRESIDENTIAL VOTING PREFERENCE BY DEMOGRAPHIC GROUP, Q2 vs. Q3 2026
Q2 vs. Q3 2026 (in Percent; lead in percentage points)

Group	Q2 Duterte	Q2 Robredo	Q2 Lead	Q3 Duterte	Q3 Robredo	Q3 Lead
AGE GROUP						
18–24	38	33	D +5	40	25	D +15
25–34	61	14	D +47	44	21	D +23
35–44	47	33	D +14	48	26	D +22
45–54	45	34	D +11	37	40	R +3
55–64	35	47	R +12	36	42	R +6
65–74	26	47	R +21	35	41	R +6
75 and above	32	61	R +29	39	42	R +3
LOCALE						
Urban	42	36	D +6	35	38	R +3
Rural	45	32	D +13	47	25	D +22
GENDER						
Male	46	31	D +15	45	28	D +17
Female	41	37	D +4	35	38	R +3
EDUCATION						
No formal / Elementary	42	49	R +7	45	32	D +13
High school	45	35	D +10	42	32	D +10
Vocational	37	29	D +8	22	46	R +24
College / Postgraduate	42	22	D +20	35	33	D +2

Notes: D = Duterte lead; R = Robredo lead. Leads are computed from rounded figures. Subgroup sizes vary widely (e.g., 34 respondents aged 75 and above and 50 with vocational education in Q3), and small-subgroup changes should be interpreted with caution.

Age. In Q2, VP Duterte's share among 25- to 34-year-olds was 61% and Mayor Robredo's among those 75 and above was 61%. In Q3, the corresponding figures are 44% and 42%. VP Duterte's share among 25- to 34-year-olds is 17 points lower than in Q2, and the undecided share in that group is 34% (25% in Q2). The 75-and-above subgroup is very small, and its figures should not be over-read. In Q3, VP Duterte leads among every age group below 45, and Mayor Robredo leads narrowly among every group 45 and above. These figures may suggest a narrower age difference than in Q2.

Locale. In urban areas, Mayor Robredo leads 38% to 35% (Q2: VP Duterte 42%, Mayor Robredo 36%). In rural areas, VP Duterte leads 47% to 25% (Q2: 45% to 32%). The urban–rural difference may be wider than in Q2.

Gender. Among women, Mayor Robredo leads 38% to 35% (Q2: VP Duterte 41%, Mayor Robredo 37%). Among men, VP Duterte leads 45% to 28% (Q2: 46% to 31%). The figures may indicate a wider gender difference than in Q2.

Education. Among respondents with no formal or elementary education, VP Duterte leads 45% to 32% (Q2: Mayor Robredo 49%, VP Duterte 42%). Among college-educated respondents, VP Duterte leads 35% to 33% (Q2: 42% to 22%). Both differences are beyond the ±3% margin of error. They sit in some tension with the class figures — Mayor Robredo's share is higher in Class E but lower among the least educated — which may indicate that class and education capture distinct segments, or that some of these differences reflect sampling variation. They should be confirmed in subsequent waves.

C.11. Overall Pattern

Taken together, the gap between the two has narrowed to seven points, from nine in Q2 and eleven in Q1, while Mayor Robredo's national share has been stable and VP Duterte continues to lead nationally. Group-level results vary: Mayor Robredo leads in NCR, Class ABC, urban areas, and among women, and drew level in Class E after an 11-point gain this quarter; VP Duterte leads in Class D, rural areas, among men and voters under 45, and in the Visayas and Mindanao. The uncommitted share, at 26%, is the largest in OCTA's 2026 tracking and is highest in Mindanao, Class D, and among younger voters. These patterns may indicate a more fluid contest than earlier in the year, though they rest on three snapshots.

D. Implications of the Survey

The Q3 results, read alongside the Q1 and Q2 waves, allow a broader reading of the matchup than either previous release on its own. They remain three survey snapshots rather than a continuous tracking series, so the patterns below may be read as indicative, not definitive.

D.1. VP Duterte remains the front-runner; the three-wave figures may indicate some softening.

VP Duterte's seven-point lead is outside the ±3% margin of error, and she leads in Class D, which carries the most weight in the national estimate, as well as in the Visayas and Mindanao. Her national share is lower in each of the three 2026 waves, and the cumulative six-point difference is larger than the margin of error. This may indicate some softening in her support over the year, though three data points are not sufficient to establish a long-term trend.

D.2. Lower figures for VP Duterte have not been matched by higher figures for Mayor Robredo.

Mayor Robredo's national share has stayed within a two-point range across three waves, while the six-point difference in VP Duterte's share is roughly matched by the seven-point difference in the uncommitted share. This may suggest that some voters are holding back from a choice rather than moving between candidates — a pattern that may be seen in NCR in Q2 and in Mindanao and Class D in Q3.

D.3. A working hypothesis — not a causal finding — for the impeachment trial and Mayor Robredo's non-candidacy.

OCTA offers the following as a working hypothesis to help interpret the quarter's movement, not as a tested causal explanation. This survey was not designed to measure the effect of either development on vote preference.

- **The impeachment trial:** Fieldwork coincided with the trial's focus on alleged unexplained wealth and corporate interests. The lower figures for VP Duterte, and the higher undecided share in Mindanao, may be associated with sustained trial coverage, which could lead some respondents to withhold commitment. The survey did not measure exposure to trial coverage, and the pattern may reflect other factors.

- **Mayor Robredo's non-candidacy:** In Q2, OCTA suggested that Mayor Robredo's statements ruling out a 2028 run may have moved some NCR respondents toward ambivalence. In Q3, her national share is within the same 33% to 35% range, and her NCR share is higher than in Q2. This may suggest that her support is not strongly affected by her stated intentions, though this, too, requires confirmation.

Both hypotheses should be validated — or set aside — as further waves become available, and particularly once the impeachment court renders its verdict.

D.4. The undecided bloc is large relative to the gap.

At 26% nationally, the uncommitted bloc is more than three times the size of VP Duterte's seven-point lead. It is highest among younger voters (roughly one in three of those aged 18 to 34), Class D, rural South Luzon, and Mindanao. Undecided voters may not behave as a single bloc, and their eventual choices are unknown; their size, however, may make them a central factor in how this matchup develops.

D.5. Group-level figures may indicate changes in the composition of support.

In Q3, Mayor Robredo leads in Class ABC, among urban residents, women, and voters aged 45 and above, and is tied with VP Duterte in Class E, where her share rose 11 points this quarter; VP Duterte leads in Class D, among rural residents, men, and voters under 45, and in the Visayas and Mindanao. Compared with Q2, age differences are smaller and urban–rural and gender differences larger. These may indicate changes in the composition of each candidate's support, but one quarter's figures should be confirmed in subsequent waves before they are treated as structural.

D.6. Two unresolved questions condition every reading of this matchup.

First, Mayor Robredo is not a declared candidate and has repeatedly said she will not seek national office in 2028; her figures measure latent standing with voters, not campaign support. Second, the impeachment trial was ongoing during fieldwork, and its outcome bears directly on the hypothetical itself, since a judgment of conviction may extend to disqualification from holding public office. Developments after fieldwork, including the narrowing of the case to a single article on October 13, are not reflected in these results.

D.7. Bottom Line

On balance, the Q3 results show the gap between VP Duterte and Mayor Robredo at seven points — the narrowest OCTA has recorded between the two in 2026, and well below the 20- to 25-point leads for VP Duterte recorded in OCTA's unpublished commissioned surveys in 2025 — with VP Duterte still on top. Across the three 2026 waves, the gap has narrowed each quarter, VP Duterte's figures are lower in each quarter, Mayor Robredo's are broadly stable, and the uncommitted share is higher.

These figures may indicate some softening in VP Duterte's support and a growing uncommitted bloc, but they rest on three snapshots. Whether this becomes a competitive 2028 race may depend on questions this survey cannot answer on its own — the outcome of the impeachment trial, whether Mayor Robredo's stated intention not to run holds, and how the uncommitted bloc eventually decides. As an early benchmark taken roughly 19 months before the May 2028 elections, these findings describe a race that may be closer and less settled than earlier in the year, not one that has been decided.

E. Appendix: Technical Details

I. LOCATION

The survey was conducted nationwide from September 28 – October 4, 2026.

National Capital Region (NCR)	Sept. 28 – Oct. 4, 2026
Balance Luzon	Sept. 28 – Oct. 4, 2026
Visayas	Sept. 28 – Oct. 4, 2026
Mindanao	Sept. 28 – Oct. 4, 2026

II. RESPONDENT AND SAMPLE SIZE

Respondents for the survey were 1,200 adult Filipinos aged 18 and above, 1,170 of whom reported being registered voters, who were interviewed face-to-face on current political, social, and economic issues as well as personal and household information.

The sample was distributed as follows:

	URBAN	RURAL
National Capital Region (NCR)	300	
Balance Luzon	165	135
North Luzon	95	50
South Luzon	70	85
Visayas	105	195
Mindanao	105	195

III. SAMPLING DESIGN

Sample sizes

Below is the distribution of the sample by area. The survey has a ±3% margin of error at the 95% confidence level.

AREA	SAMPLE SIZE
TOTAL PHILIPPINES	**1,200**
National Capital Region	**300**
North/Central Luzon	**145**
Cordillera Administrative Region	10
Region I	35
Region II	25
Region III	75
Southern Luzon	**155**
Region IV-A	100
Region IV-B	20
Region V	35
Visayas	**300**
Region VI	80
Region VII	95
Region VIII	65
NIR (Negros Island Region)	60
Mindanao	**300**
Region IX	55
Region X	60
Region XI	60
Region XII	50
CARAGA	30
BARMM	45

IV. SAMPLING SCHEME

The number of sample barangays was distributed among the 17 regions proportional to population size. In each sample barangay, five (5) probability respondents were selected.

AREA	SAMPLE BARANGAYS	PROBABILITY RESPONDENTS
TOTAL PHILIPPINES	**240**	**1,200**
National Capital Region	**60**	**300**
North/Central Luzon	**29**	**145**
Cordillera Administrative Region	2	10
Region I	7	35
Region II	5	25
Region III	15	75
Southern Luzon	**31**	**155**
Region IV-A	20	100
Region IV-B	4	20
Region V	7	35
Visayas	**60**	**300**
Region VI	16	80
Region VII	19	95
Region VIII	13	65
NIR (Negros Island Region)	12	60
Mindanao	**60**	**300**
Region IX	11	55
Region X	12	60
Region XI	12	60
Region XII	10	50
CARAGA	6	30
BARMM	9	45

For the National Capital Region:

- Stage 1: Selection of Sample Barangays – Sixty (60) barangays were distributed among the 17 cities and municipalities in such a way that each city/municipality was assigned a number of barangays that is roughly proportional to its population size. An additional provision was that each municipality must have one sample barangay. Barangays were randomly selected without replacement from within each city/municipality.

- Stage 2: Selection of Sample Households – In each sample barangay, interval sampling was used to draw 5 sample households. A starting street corner was drawn at random. The first sample household was randomly selected from the households nearest to the starting street corner. Subsequently, every 6th household was sampled.

- Stage 3: Selection of the Sample Adult – In each selected household, a respondent was randomly chosen from among household members who were 18 years of age and older, using a probability selection table. To ensure that half of the respondents were male and half were female, only male family members were pre-listed in the probability selection table of odd-numbered questionnaires while only female members were pre-listed for even-numbered questionnaires. In cases where there was no qualified respondent of a given gender, the interval sampling of households was continued until five sample respondents were identified.

For the rest of the Philippines:

- Stage 1: Allocation of sample barangays to Regions – The number of barangays allocated to each region was proportional to population size.

- Stage 2: Allocation and Selection of Sample Cities/Municipalities to Regions – Within each region, cities/municipalities were allocated to the regions in proportion to household population size. Sample cities/municipalities were selected without replacement and with probability proportional to household population size.

- Stage 3: Selection of Sample Barangays – Once the cities/municipalities have been selected, the allocated number of barangays were distributed among the sample cities/municipalities in such a way that each city/municipality was assigned a number of barangays roughly proportional to its household population size. However, it was ensured that each city/municipality will be assigned at least one sample barangay. Sample barangays within each sample city/municipality were randomly selected without replacement.

- Stage 4: Selection of Sample Households – Within each sample barangay, five households were selected through interval sampling. In sample urban barangays, a random corner was identified, a random start generated, and the sampling interval used was five. In rural barangays, the designated starting point could be a school, the barangay captain's house, a church/chapel, or a barangay/municipal hall and the interval was one.

- Stage 5: Selection of the Sample Adult – In each selected household, a respondent was randomly chosen from among household members who were 18 years of age and older, using a probability selection table. To ensure that half of the respondents were male and half were female, only male family members were pre-listed in the probability selection table of odd-numbered questionnaires while only female members were pre-listed for even-numbered questionnaires. In cases where there was no qualified respondent of a given gender, the interval sampling of households was continued until five sample respondents were identified.

V. RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

A. Questionnaire

1. The list of information included in the survey questionnaire that was used for the study was provided by subscribers and OCTA. The final questionnaire was then constructed by the OCTA Project Team and was prepared in Filipino with its corresponding English translation. The questionnaire was also translated into the following languages (Bicol, Cebuano, Ilocano, Ilonggo) for use in different areas covered in the survey.

2. Field interviewers that were commissioned for the study underwent extensive training prior to deployment. The objectives of the study, the questionnaire, interview techniques and interval sampling for the fieldwork coverage were discussed in detail during the training. The training was conducted face to face and online in central locations across the country namely Quezon City, Cebu City, Iloilo City, Zamboanga City and Davao City.

B. Data Gathering and Supervision

1. **Supervision:** Field Supervisors reporting to the Field Manager monitored the data gathering for the study full-time. They observed (12% of total interviews), followed up and conducted surprise checks on the field interviewers. They also ensured that field logistics were received promptly and administered properly.

2. **Data Gathering:** Spot checking was done at various stages of fieldwork. The first one took place after about 30% of interviews were completed. The second spot-checking was conducted after 60% completion and the last one, immediately after 90% completion of interviewing. As spot checking was undertaken (21% of the total interviews that were not observed by the field supervisors) at various stages of the fieldwork, the unsupervised interviews were re-interviewed/backchecked. If serious errors persisted after spot checking, the original interviews were invalidated and respondents were re-interviewed. An error was considered serious if there was evidence of dishonest recording of responses or if there was a serious misinterpretation of the study that resulted in incorrect information.

3. **Number of Calls and Substitution:** Respondents sampled who were not available during first attempt were booked for an appointment within the day. Two (2) valid call backs were made within the same day and if the probability respondent was still not available, a substitute who possessed the same qualities (in terms of gender, age bracket, working status and socio-economic class) as the original respondent was interviewed. The substitute respondent was taken from another household beyond the covered intervals in the sample barangay.

4. **Field Editing:** After each interview, the interviewer was asked to go over his/her own work and check for consistency. All accomplished questionnaires were submitted to the assigned group supervisor who, in turn, reviewed at least 50% of total interviews. If there were persistent errors, 100% of questionnaires would be reviewed.

C. Data Encoding and Processing

1. **Data Encoding:** A data encoding program customized and validated by a Data Processing Manager was used for data entry. The said program further checked the consistency and completeness

of the data gathered before generating the required data tables for analysis. To ensure the quality of data, 74% of the completed interviews were encoded twice and checked for accuracy and consistency.

2. **Preliminary Data Processing:** Preliminary data tables were generated to check the quality of the data encoding done. Specifically, the encoded data was checked for accuracy of variable labels, variable values, and completeness and consistency of data entries.